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Node.js — JavaScript Meets World

>>If you've even vaguely kept up to date with web development news, you've likely heard of Node.js > by Kshitij Sobti

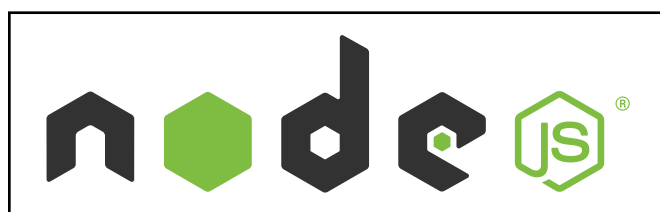
Introduction

Yes, JavaScript has indeed escaped the confinement of the browser, and is now available as a scripting language that works somewhat like Ruby or Python. You write applications as JavaScript files, and run them using Node.js which includes libraries for some common tasks.

Often programming languages are designed to be general purpose and then get embedded as the scripting language for an application. For instance Python scripts can be used to control parts of Maya, a popular 3D design application. JavaScript has taken the reverse approach!

JavaScript was designed from the beginning to be a scripting language for the browser. It was confined within the browser, and only had access to modify the web page loaded in the browser. As browsers have become more powerful JavaScript has become more central to our idea of the web. Today running a browser with JavaScript disabled is no longer a viable option.

Full complex web applications such as image edition, word processors and more have been built in JavaScript. Even so there are limitation to what JavaScript can do withing a web page, and for good reason! However, this is not a restriction of the language



itself, but rather the environment (the browser) in which it runs. Node.js provides an alternate environment for JavaScript to run in. It builds upon the V8 engine from Google's Chrome browser, and provides a runtime for it that makes JavaScript applications viable.

Node.js isn't the only runtime to allow running JavaScript outside the browser, neither was it the first. It is however the most popular JavaScript runtime developing JavaScript applications thanks to its extensive and powerful API, and the growing ecosystem of libraries, modules and packages around it.

As a developer today, it is impossible to avoid JavaScript. It is one of the most popular programming languages in the world. JavaScript is the only language that all major web browsers understand. If you develop client-side applications for the web, you're already

*Coding Matters



*Node using Chakra

>>Chakra, Microsoft's JavaScript engine used by IE and Edge was made open source, and now effort is underway to enable it as an alternative to Google's V8 in Node.js
<http://dgkit.in/NChakra>



*Angular JS 1.5

>>Google's AngularJS framework is being overhauled for its 2.0 release, till then they have released v1.5 to help developers smoothen the transition.
<http://dgkit.in/Angular1-5>



*JavaScript Module Guide

>>This article looks at all the different systems available to developers for modularising their code. It covers different module systems and more.
<http://dgkit.in/JScriptMG>